

Japonisme

Whistler, Degas, Cassatt, Manet, Van Gogh and many other artists were fascinated by Japanese design, and many collected *Ukiyo-e* prints. After 200 years of isolation from the West, Japan began trading with the rest of the world in 1853. This led to a plethora of goods, including prints, textiles and artefacts arriving for sale in Europe from Japan. Japanese goods were also displayed at exhibitions such as the 1862 International Exhibition in London, and the 1867 Exposition Universelle in Paris. A craze for all things Japanese swept through France and Britain in particular, influencing paintings, fashions and decoration. In 1872, art critic Philippe Burty (1830–90) named the trend 'Japonisme'.

Japanese art had an appreciable effect on several European movements including Impressionism, Post-Impressionism and Art Nouveau. Many artists reinterpreted *Ukiyo-e* motifs, such as Pissarro with his wintry landscapes, Whistler's butterfly symbol, Monet's painting of Madame Monet in a kimono, and Van Gogh's replications of his own collection of Japanese prints.



Van Gogh, *The Courtesan*, 1887